Arolygiaeth Gofal Cymru
Care Inspectorate Wales

Inspection Report on

Forestry House

Neath

28th November 2022

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About Forestry House

Type of care provided	Care Home Service Childrens Home
Registered Provider	Priority Childcare Limited
Registered places	6
Language of the service	English
Previous Care Inspectorate Wales inspection	January 2022
Does this service provide the Welsh Language active offer?	This service is working towards providing an 'Active Offer' of the Welsh language and demonstrates a significant effort to promoting the use of the Welsh language and culture.

Summary

Forestry House provides care and support for six young people between the age of five and nineteen. Young people are supported to achieve positive well-being outcomes and care staff are motivated and inclusive in developing strategies to increase young people's engagement.

Since the last inspection the service provider has focused on the suitability of their service for young people and sustaining and improving the areas of development identified in 2021. The overall governance and management of the service is a good standard and provides assurances it is committed to continuous improvement and development.

Work is required to continue improving the environment, with particular attention to bedrooms and bathroom facilities and the manager advised there is a development plan in place.

Well-being

Young people are provided with a guide to the service, which is user friendly and covers most required information, however it does not support young people to access the right information when they need it as the guide does not include guidance on how to raise a complaint and important contact information for the Responsible Individual and Care Inspectorate Wales (CIW). Young people told us they would not know who to speak to or how to raise a concern.

The service provider promotes the physical and emotional well-being of young people, registering them with universal health services including a General Practitioner (GP), Dentist and creating individual health plans. Care staff promote healthy habits and routines, and records demonstrate routine welfare checks are completed for young people spending time in their bedrooms. Young people are encouraged to attend education, although not all young people attend consistently. As a result, the service provider has sought alternative educational support for young people who have disengaged form mainstream school.

Care staff ensure young people's individual circumstances are considered and take proactive action to ensure they do things which matter to them. Young people are supported to practice their religion and transport is provided to ensure they can celebrate their religion within a community they are comfortable in. When young people raise concerns over their placement, the service advocates on their behalf through Local Authority meetings and in consultation with other external professionals to ensure their voice is heard.

Young people are cared for by a team of care staff who have completed safeguarding training and understand their role in protecting young people from harm. The manager completes good quality safeguarding records including a detailed chronology and evidence of the outcome from the Local Authority Safeguarding Board is documented. Safeguarding referrals are submitted in a timely manner and CIW are notified appropriately. Young people told us they feel safe at Forestry House.

The service regularly engages young people in house meetings where topics such as behaviours, Christmas and menus are discussed. Care staff should ensure the focus of meetings are on the well-being and voice of young people and not a negative discussion on incidents or behaviours, this has been raised by the Responsible Individual within their regulatory visits.

Care and Support

The service provider completes pre-admission paperwork, including transition visits to provide assurances to young people and Local Authorities they can provide young people with their assessed care and support needs. Provider assessments are completed which offer detail of young people's needs and these are reviewed. However, further development is needed to ensure records detail how care staff will support young people's outcomes. Compatibility risk assessments are completed and evidence how risk will be mitigated to ensure the safety of young people. External professionals told us Forestry House is a good service.

Young people have personal plans which are outcome focused and detail clear actions on how care staff will support them to achieve their well-being outcomes. Records include a child friendly plan written in the voice of young people and an outcome status log which celebrates the achievements they have made. The manager and care staff complete three monthly evaluations where they review and plan young people's outcome plans and although engagement from young people is limited care staff actively try to capture their voice throughout.

Risk assessments are completed at the point of admission and records include possible triggers and both preventative and reactive strategies to keep young people safe from harm. Records demonstrate risk assessments are reviewed appropriately and when new risky behaviours are identified, further risk assessments are completed.

Although young people receive keyworker sessions regularly, more work is needed to ensure this time is planned, purposeful and supports them to achieve their well-being outcomes. Care staff encourage young people to have control over their day- to -day life by completing their own activity planners, supporting their independent living skills, and completing monthly feedback surveys on topics such as their safety and the menu. Young people complete food shopping with the support of care staff and many prepare their own meals. Care staff have implemented incentive charts to support young people to achieve positive outcomes and consequences appeared appropriate, however some feel consequences can be too harsh.

Environment

Forestry House is a five-bedroom home, with the addition of an independent flat. There are large grounds which are suitably maintained. Effort has been made to provide an environment conducive of a family home, specifically in the downstairs, communal areas with soft furnishing and colourful paintings. Young people told us they like living at Forestry house. Work is required to improve the upstairs rooms.

Young people are supported to personalise their bedroom's; however, we saw limited personalisation of rooms and most bedrooms appeared unkempt. Storage for young people is limited and support is not provided to organise and take care of their belongings, however young people told us they have everything they need in their bedrooms. Damage has been caused to the bathroom which, although reported to maintenance has not been rectified. The bathroom is unkempt and has many areas of damage and urgent attention is required to ensure young people have access to a clean, suitably functioning bathroom. The Responsible Individual has provided CIW assurances environmental improvements will be completed in the new year.

The independent flat is currently not in use due to extensive damage and is undergoing a full refurbishment. The service provider told us there are no plans for any young people to use the flat in the near future.

Maintenance records evidence care staff take appropriate action to ensure the environment promotes the well-being of young people and risk of harm is mitigated. However, maintenance works are not always completed in a suitable time frame or finished to a good standard. Health and Safety checks including fire evacuations are completed regularly and visitors are required to sign into the visitors book.

Leadership and Management

Forestry House supports young people with a full-time manager and a full complement of care staff, providing consistency of care and supporting positive relationships. There is a senior management structure in place including the Responsible Individual and a Regional Manager who are present and supportive within the service. Care staff spoke positively about the Responsible Individual and Regional Manager, and the encouraging and positive culture which is demonstrated by all who work at the service

Young people can be assured they are cared for by care staff who have been subject to safe recruitment checks. The service provider completes regulatory checks prior to the appointment of new care staff including identification checks, verification of references and checks to the Disclosure and Baring Service (DBS). New care staff complete a corporate inhouse induction, however many care staff provided feedback to CIW stating the content is not always appropriate or purposeful for those working with care experienced young people.

Improvements have been made to the training and supervision of care staff and the service now provides young people with a complement of fully trained care staff in line with the Statement of Purpose and bespoke training has been provided to ensure care and support needs of young people can be met. Young people can be assured care staff are supported and supervised and are reflective in their practice to continue developing their skills and knowledge. A focus on praise, well-being and development is evidenced throughout supervision records. Care staff told us supervision sessions are purposeful and concerns about practice are managed appropriately.

The Responsible Individual visits the service and completes their regulatory reports. Regulatory reports evidence consultation with young people, care staff and external professionals and identify strengths and areas for improvement. Actions are listed and reviewed during each period of visits. Not all care staff understood the role of the Responsible Individual but stated they would be confident in speaking to them or the Regional Manager if they were concerned about young people or the service provision.

Summary of Non-Compliance	
Status	**What each means**
New	This non-compliance was identified at this inspection.
Reviewed	Compliance was reviewed at this inspection and was not achieved. The target date for compliance is in the future and will be tested at next inspection.
Not Achieved	Compliance was tested at this inspection and was not achieved.
Achieved	Compliance was tested at this inspection and was achieved.

We respond to non-compliance with regulations where poor outcomes for people, and / or risk to people's well-being are identified by issuing Priority Action Notice (s).

The provider must take immediate steps to address this and make improvements. Where providers fail to take priority action by the target date we may escalate the matter to an Improvement and Enforcement Panel.

Priority Action Notice(s)		
Regulation	Summary	Status
N/A	No non-compliance of this type was identified at this inspection	N/A

Where we find non-compliance with regulations but no immediate or significant risk for people using the service is identified we highlight these as Areas for Improvement.

We expect the provider to take action to rectify this and we will follow this up at the next inspection. Where the provider has failed to make the necessary improvements we will escalate the matter by issuing a Priority Action Notice.

Area(s) for Improvement		
Regulation	Summary	Status

N/A	No non-compliance of this type was identified at this inspection	N/A

Date Published 22/12/2022